

# Gelbach decomposition of age gradient

*Govt. should concern itself with income differences (Own survey, 2025)*

53.6% explained,  $\beta_{short} = -0.209$ ,  $\beta_{full} = -0.097$ ,  $N = 2,413$

*tier 2 candidate variables: beliefs, worldview/values, position*

| #  | Item                                                      | Contribution | % of explained |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------|
| 1  | people get rich at others' expense, not by creating value | -0.039       | 34.5%          |
| 2  | DEI creates opportunity for some at others' expense       | -0.019       | 17.3%          |
| 3  | r is currently a student                                  | -0.014       | 12.1%          |
| 4  | job-value rank: growth/advancement                        | -0.012       | 10.3%          |
| 5  | perceived risk of relocating due to climate events (10yr) | -0.011       | 9.7%           |
| 6  | employment status: student                                | 0.010        | -9.3%          |
| 7  | CEO pay gains came at expense of average workers          | -0.006       | 5.8%           |
| 8  | r's education will pay off economically                   | -0.006       | 5.2%           |
| 9  | how worried r is about losing/not finding a job           | -0.006       | 5.1%           |
| 10 | harder or easier to move up now vs. parents' day          | -0.006       | 5.1%           |

— 54 items with <5% contribution omitted —